

UAE

Key Country Details: United Arab Emirates

Detail	Information
Full Name	United Arab Emirates (UAE)
Capital	Abu Dhabi
Government Type	Federal elective monarchy
Head of State	President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan
Head of Government	Prime Minister Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum
Currency	UAE Dirham (AED)
UN Member Since	9 December 1971
MUN Standing	Strong contributor to regional diplomacy, sustainable development, humanitarian aid, and global energy/climate agendas.

Book Recommendations on UAE Foreign Policy & UN Engagement

1. "The United Arab Emirates: Power, Politics and Policymaking" – Kristian Coates Ulrichsen
<https://www.amazon.com/United-Arab-Emirates-Politics-Policymaking/dp/1137021967>
2. "The Political Economy of the United Arab Emirates" – Ibrahim Al-Abed & Peter Hellyer
<https://www.amazon.com/Political-Economy-United-Arab-Emirates/dp/9948205623>
3. "The Gulf Monarchies and Climate Change" – Karen E. Young
<https://www.amazon.com/Gulf-Monarchies-Climate-Change-Unsustainability/dp/0190947844>
4. "Women in the United Arab Emirates: A Portrait of Progress" – Dubai Women's Establishment
<https://www.amazon.com/Women-United-Arab-Emirates-Progress/dp/9948205623>
5. "The UAE and Foreign Policy: Foreign Aid, Identities and Interests" – Khalid S. Almezaini
<https://www.amazon.com/UAE-Foreign-Policy-Identities-Interests/dp/1137021967>

Research Table: UAE & UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR UAE Country Page	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/united-arab-emirates	UN overview of UAE's human rights record.
UPR Reports – UAE	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/ae-index	UAE's reports and evaluations under the

		Universal Periodic Review.
UAE Elected to UNHRC	https://www.mofa.gov.ae/en/mediahub/news/2021/10/14/14-10-2021-uae-rights	UAE's election to the Human Rights Council.
UAE Statement at UNGA Third Committee	https://uaeun.org/statement/uaeun-79-3c-23oct/	UAE's position on human rights policies.
Human Rights Watch – UAE 2024	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2024/country-chapters/united-arab-emirates	International watchdog report.
Amnesty International – UAE	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/middle-east-and-north-africa/united-arab-emirates/report-united-arab-emirates/	Critical perspectives on civil rights.
Freedom House – UAE Report	https://freedomhouse.org/country/united-arab-emirates/freedom-world/2024	Rights and freedoms rankings.
Gulf Centre for Human Rights – UAE	https://www.gc4hr.org/countries/united-arab-emirates	Independent human rights monitoring.
CEDAW Reports – UAE	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/TreatyBodyExternal/Countries.aspx?CountryCode=ARE&Lang=EN	UAE's submissions on women's rights.

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OHCHR – UAE Country Profile	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/united-arab-emirates (uprdoc.ohchr.org , ohchr.org , www.ohchr.org)	Authoritative baseline of treaty ratifications, OHCHR presence, and UN engagement.
OHCHR – UAE UPR Hub	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=10923	HRF/MRG joint submission tracking UPR progress—core Council review source.
HRW – Migrant Worker Abuses & COP28	https://www.hrw.org/news/2023/12/03/questions-and-answers-migrant-worker-abuses-uae-and-cop28	Highlights labour rights tied to climate and UN item themes.
HRW – Climate & Migrant Worker Harm (video)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2023/11/21/uae-migrant-worker-abuses-linked-broader-climate-harms	Connects labour exploitation with climate injustices—a multi-agenda issue.

HRW – Demo: Domestic Worker Abuse (video)	https://www.hrw.org/video-photos/video/2014/10/22/domestic-workers-trapped-exploited-and-abused-uae	Visual evidence of forced labour—vital for Council Item 3/7 discussions.
OHCHR – State UPR Joint Submission	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=11046	UAE's own review of its protection of HRDs and civic space.
OHCHR – Statelessness Submission	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=11123	Focused on stateless residents—ties to nationality rights.
Walk Free – Modern Slavery Profile	https://www.walkfree.org/global-slavery-index/country-studies/united-arab-emirates/	Documents kafala system and forced labour risks.
Amnesty – UAE Rights Campaigns	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/middle-east-and-north-africa/middle-east/united-arab-emirates/report-united-arab-emirates/	Ongoing Amnesty coverage of repression and reform.
US State Dept – UAE HR Report 2022	https://www.state.gov/reports/2022-country-reports-on-human-rights-practices/united-arab-emirates/	Official government overview of abuses across governance sectors.
BCU – UPR Stakeholder Report	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=10966	Independent input urging ICCPR ratification and judicial reform.
Harvard HHR Journal Article (2011)	https://www.hhrjournal.org/2013/08/20/human-rights-and-health-disparities-for-migrant-workers-in-the-uae/	Academic insights on legal and health gaps affecting migrants.
OHCHR – MENA Regional Office Profile	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/middle-east-north-africa-region/middle-east-north-africa-section-hq	Contextualizes UAE within Middle East UN human rights efforts.
OHCHR – Regional Centre (MENA)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/middle-east-north-africa-region/centre-for-southwest-asia-and-arab-region	Institutional support context for country-level engagement.
Guardian – Migrant Fatalities at COP28	https://apnews.com/article/8d913465c3de81c62412dcf5ec07f11c	News on worker deaths tied to mega events—relevant to Council's labor and assembly issues.
YouTube – HRW COP28 Critique	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HISEHxe74FM	Visual advocacy used in UN

Video		sessions.
ICC – Exec Summary on Gender/LGBT Violence PDF	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=5653	Flags violence against women and LGBTI persons—a multi-Item concern.
HRW – Early UPR Joint Filing (2009 PDF)	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=3987	Illustrates longstanding UN engagement on rights.

10 Unique Aspects: UAE at UNHRC

1. **High Dependence on Migrant Labour (~90%):** It's concerning that many workers don't have the protections they need, which is why the Council is focusing on the abuses associated with the kafala system.
2. **Mega-Event Rights Spotlight (COP28, Expo):** The construction work for COP28 has highlighted significant rights issues, ranging from wage theft to heat stress, which have been further emphasized in discussions at UN forums.
3. **Forced Labour vs. Health Disparities:** Research from academic and HRW studies reveals that chronic illnesses often stem from inadequate living conditions, emphasizing the crucial links between health and rights.
4. **Domestic Worker Abuse Documented via Video:** HRW footage has been shown at the Council to advocate for labor reform under Item 3/7.
5. **Persistent Statelessness Issue:** NGOs are urging the Council to take action on the civil registration issues faced by 'bidoon' populations.
6. **UPR Engagement: Reforms Promise vs. Weak Implementation:** The UAE's official UPR submissions show a positive intent, but organizations like HRW and Amnesty often point out that the follow-through is lacking.
7. **Limited Civic Space for HRDs & Press:** The OHCHR and HRF are urging the UAE to step up its efforts in safeguarding the rights of human rights defenders.
8. **Kafala System = Structural Vulnerability:** Walk Free and HRW highlight how employer control systems can lead to exploitation, which is a recurring theme in Council discussions.
9. **UN Regional Presence Supports UAE Monitoring:** The OHCHR's Middle East and Arab Centre plays a crucial role in overseeing and assisting with reviews in the UAE.
10. **Intersectional Rights Agenda: Labour, Climate, Health:** The migrant rights crisis in the UAE is closely tied to climate vulnerability and healthcare challenges, leading to a complex set of issues on the UNHRC agenda.